



RSU Global!

JANUARY 2026

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As January begins, RSU Global continues to grow as a space where students feel welcomed, supported, and encouraged to learn together. What makes our community special is not only the programs we run, but the people behind them and the ones who show up,

support one another, and help create positive learning experiences for everyone.

As the Student Commissioner of RSU Global, I am grateful to work with such a dedicated team. Our Head Team Leaders show strong responsibility and clear communication, helping our mentoring programs run smoothly.

I sincerely thank our mentors for their time, effort, and support. Through your guidance, students gain confidence, improve communication skills, and grow both academically and personally.

Together, we have built a respectful and supportive community where students feel comfortable learning and sharing ideas. This month's newsletter reflects our continued progress, and I look forward to moving forward together and making this semester meaningful for everyone.

We remain committed to strengthening our mentoring initiatives and creating more opportunities for student development. Let us continue to support one another with positivity, teamwork, and shared purpose. I am confident that together we will achieve even greater success in the months ahead.

RIC PEER MENTOR OF THE MONTH



A peer mentor is a fellow student who guides and supports others, helping them adjust to university life. Peer mentors play an important role in supporting students

academically and emotionally. They offer study tips, language practice, and learning resources while providing encouragement that builds confidence. They also help new learners during orientation and create a friendly, welcoming environment.

Peer mentors help bridge the gap between students and teachers, making learners feel more connected, motivated, and supported. Through their guidance, they promote teamwork, collaboration, and a positive learning culture within the Language Center.

Looking ahead, the goal is to have more peer mentors throughout the semester to strengthen the community and provide more personalized support. Each month, one peer mentor is recognized for their dedication, commitment, and positive impact on students and the Language Center. We truly appreciate their dedication and hard work. Their positive impact continues to inspire both students and staff.

CULTURE CORNER



Karen New Year is an important cultural celebration for the Karen people of Myanmar and Thailand, observed in late December or early January according to the traditional lunar calendar. The festival marks the start of a new agricultural cycle and symbolizes renewal, unity, and hope. Communities welcome the day with ceremonies led by elders, the raising of bamboo poles, and the rhythmic sounds of traditional drums. Many people wear beautifully woven Karen clothing and participate in the graceful don dance, which represents harmony and togetherness. Families gather at village grounds to share meals, listen to cultural songs, and celebrate their heritage with pride. Although Karen New Year is not as large as major national festivals, it carries

deep meaning for the Karen community. The celebration encourages respect for elders, gratitude for the past year, and prayers for peace and good harvests. Youth groups join in through music, sports, and storytelling that keep their traditions alive, while families come together to honor ancestors and strengthen community bonds. Overall, Karen New Year is a warm reminder of identity, unity, and resilience as people step into a hopeful new beginning.

PROGRAMS IN ACTION: HOW RSU GLOBAL! ALIGNS WITH THESE RIC COURSES:

ENL/ILE 125: ENGLISH FOR GLOBAL EXPLORATION

This course helps students build a strong English foundation while exploring global issues and cultures.



This course is part of RIC's core English foundation program and supports RSU GLOBAL!'s commitment to fostering global awareness and cross-cultural understanding. Students build their communication and presentation skills through interactive activities, cultural exchanges, and collaborative learning with PAL mentors. By engaging in diverse discussions, learners gain the confidence to express their ideas in multicultural settings. In addition to improving language proficiency, the course encourages curiosity, teamwork, and meaningful connections across cultures.

ENL/ILE 126: ENGLISH IN TED

This course focuses on speaking and presentation skills through a TED-style learning approach.



This course enhances students' speaking and presentation skills using a TED-inspired format. It promotes creativity, clarity, and confidence while helping students develop strong persuasive communication skills. Learners practice organizing their ideas, incorporating storytelling techniques, and engaging audiences effectively. With guidance from mentors, students build confidence in delivering well-structured, impactful presentations and expressing their ideas in a professional and inspiring manner to international audiences.

ENL/ILE 127: ENGLISH AT WORK

Designed in line with RSU GLOBAL!'s goals, this course emphasizes practical English skills for professional and real-world workplace settings.



Students develop effective communication through interactive exercises, role-plays, and mentor-led discussions that reflect authentic business scenarios. With a strong focus on teamwork, critical thinking, and intercultural communication, learners practice expressing themselves clearly in meetings, interviews, and collaborative tasks. The course equips students with the confidence and professionalism needed to succeed in diverse working environments. They also develop stronger problem-solving skills through active participation and discussion. As a result, students become more prepared to communicate effectively in international settings.

RSU/IRS 127: INTERCULTURAL COMMUNICATION

Aligned with RSU GLOBAL!'s mission, this course prepares students to communicate successfully across



cultural differences. Through interactive activities, group projects, and collaboration with PAL mentors, students develop greater cultural awareness, empathy, and adaptability. Participants gain the confidence and understanding needed to engage respectfully in global conversations. The course equips learners with essential intercultural communication skills for success in diverse academic, professional, and social settings, while encouraging them to become open-minded global citizens who contribute positively to international communities. Ultimately, these experiences help students build meaningful connections across cultures and perspectives.

UPCOMING PEER MENTOR TRAINING MODULES BY OUR PRODEV TEAM:

Professional Communication For Global Mentors

This training module helps mentors understand how different ways of using English can affect communication and mentoring. It focuses on listening



with an open mind, respecting different backgrounds, and understanding each person's identity. For peer mentors, language awareness is more than just correct grammar. It is about listening without judgment and valuing how others express themselves. Through group discussions and reflection activities, mentors learn to be more empathetic and open. This helps build trust, improve teamwork, and support RSU Global's goal of intercultural understanding.

Collaborative Projects Design and Innovation

This module introduces a mentoring approach that encourages mentors and mentees to work together on meaningful projects. The focus is on teamwork,



creativity, and shared learning. By working collaboratively, mentees become more motivated and confident, while mentors learn how to guide projects in a supportive way. This approach helps everyone learn from real experiences, encourages continuous improvement, and develops creative thinking. These skills are important not only during university life but also for future careers. As a result, both mentors and mentees grow together, building leadership, responsibility and learning skills.

Research Projects Planned:

Dr. Edward's Research Factory

During the January academic period, a research study titled "Peer-Assisted Learning as a Platform for Intercultural Engagement: Evidence from Thai Health Sciences and Business Administration Students" is being conducted. This study focuses on exploring how Peer-Assisted Learning (PAL) serves as an effective platform for fostering intercultural engagement among Thai undergraduate students.

By examining collaborative learning environments, the research investigates how students from diverse cultural backgrounds interact, communicate, and support one another academically. The study places particular emphasis on students from Health Sciences and Business Administration programs, highlighting how PAL encourages the development of mutual understanding, teamwork, and cross-cultural communication skills.

The findings are expected to demonstrate that Peer-Assisted Learning not only enhances academic performance but also plays a significant role in building intercultural competence. Through structured peer interaction, students gain exposure to different perspectives, helping them become more adaptable and culturally aware in both academic and professional settings.

This research paper is scheduled to be presented at the upcoming RSU Conference, contributing valuable insights into innovative learning strategies and their impact on intercultural development in higher education.

Thai Mentees

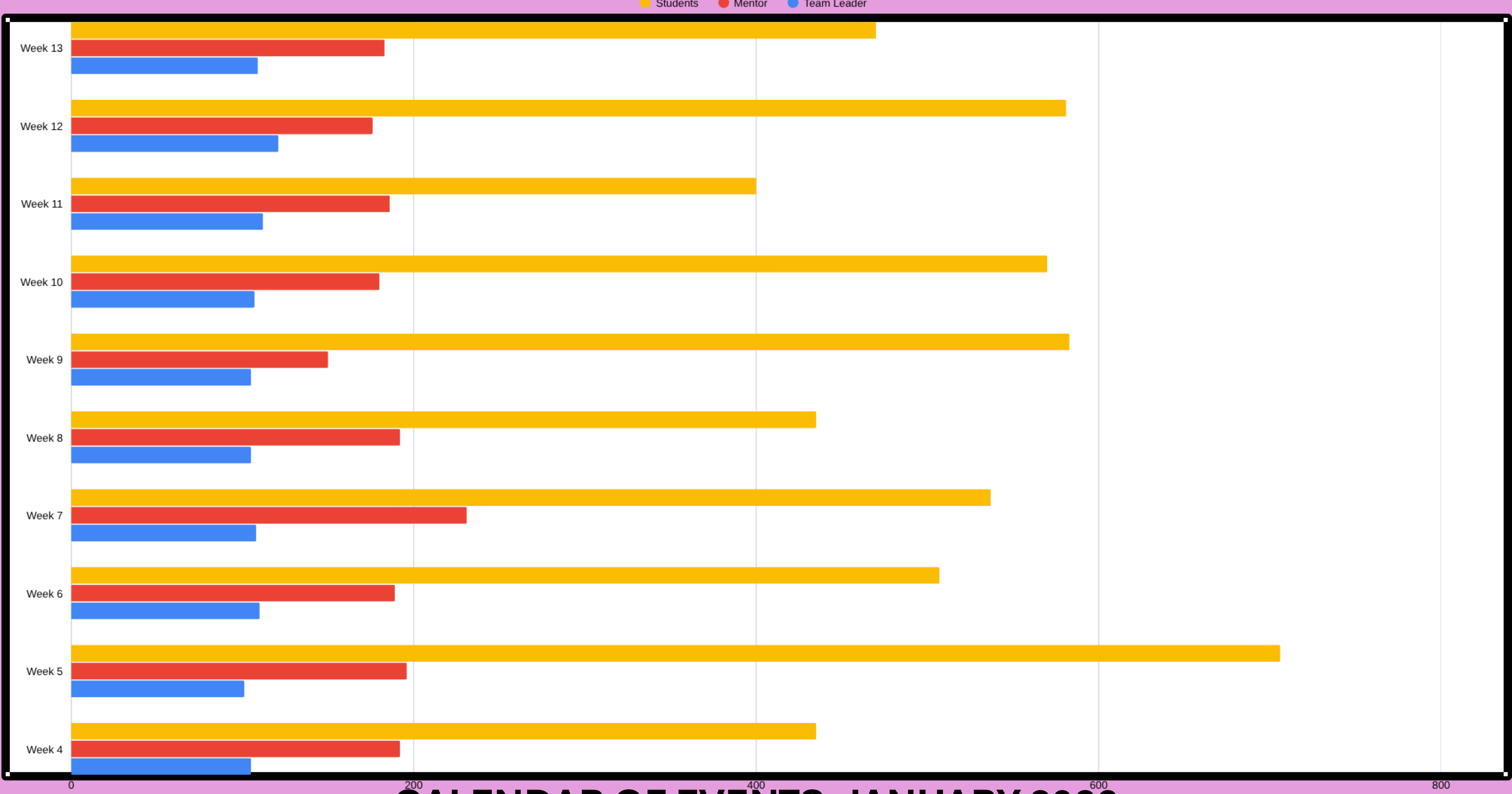
ENL/ILE 126: English In TED (Thai Program)

Students in ENL 126 improve their English speaking skills through active interaction and collaboration with international peer mentors. They take part in discussions, debates, and communication activities in a friendly and supportive environment.



Through these activities, Thai students gain confidence to express their ideas clearly and naturally. They also develop important communication and presentation skills that can be used in real-life situations, such as public speaking, academic discussions, and professional communication. These experiences help prepare them to communicate effectively in both local and international environments.

IMPACTED BY THE NUMBERS: PARTICIPANT NUMBERS FOR JANUARY 2026:



CALENDAR OF EVENTS: JANUARY 2026

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
28	29	30	31	New Year's Day 1	New Year Holiday 2	3
4	5	6	7	8	RIC Orientation 9	10
Academic Week #1 11	First Day of Classes 12	13	14	15	16	17
Academic Week #2 21	22	23	24	RSU Anniversary Day 25	26	27
Academic Week #3 28	29	30	31			